

CHAPTER 23

A REALISATION OF LOVE

'I will be your body guard.'

I got bail. It was fifty days since I was arrested. The jail authorities anticipated trouble from the public when I was to step out, on 19 January 1995. People were angry at the 'traitors', and they would vent their anger primarily at me, an officer said with a clearly put on concern. I said there would be no such trouble, and if at all anything happened I knew how to protect myself.

When Sankar came to take me home along with my relative G Subramanian, I was surprised to find an old friend accompanying them. It was John George, the fitter. After being fired for his fracas with a colleague on the work floor, John had come to me for help. I was helpless as Seshan, the administrative head, had got presidential sanction to sack John who would then have not even legal remedy. I had thought that John would hate me for not protecting his job; after all he had been seen as my right hand man even as he flexed his muscles to extract work from others.

John said he losing the job was his own making; though he was upset with me for not being able to reinstate him, he now thought that it was time to stand by me.

'I heard some people may create nuisance to you when you come out of the prison,' John said as I was collecting my meagre belongings from the prison superintendent. 'I will be your body guard till you reach home.'